

Diablo II



The bosses are a piece of cake when you are the Barbarian. Just keep your quickslots filled with health potions—hack, gulp and repeat

■ The Barbarian

The Barbarian is the best melee fighter. His brutish strength allows him to hack through hordes of enemies much like a hot knife glides through butter.

excellent dexterity gives her high Attack and Defense ratings, which when combined



with the skills that she can unlock at higher levels, makes her one mean killing machine. Temper her character with these skills: Cold Arrow, Multiple Shot, Immolation Arrow, Freezing Arrow, Critical Strike, Penetrate, Decoy and Evade. Titan's Revenge, Lycander's Aim and Lycander's Flank are the unique weapons that you should keep an eye out for while playing as an Amazon.

■ The Amazon

The Amazon lets her bow and arrow do the talking; and she isn't half bad with the spear either! Her

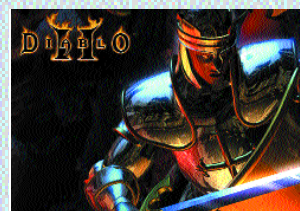
■ The Necromancer

The Necromancer is the summoner of all things

mean and undead and should be looked upon as an army general who lets others do all the dirty work while he meanders in the background casting spells and cursing away. Amplify Damage, Confuse and Attract (especially when used in conjunction with Confuse) are some of the curses that along with spells and skills like Bone Armor, Corpse Explosion, Bone Spear, Bone Spirit, Golem Mastery, Clay Golem, Iron Golem and Revive, should be part of your Necromancer's repertoire. The Homunculus is by far the best shield any Necromancer could hope to find.

■ The Paladin

The Paladin is an aura dude. While hacking your way through the single player mode, Offensive Auras are a must (Concentration and Holy Freeze, for example). Multiplayer romps demand investment in Defensive Auras like Defiance, Meditation, Redemption and



Salvation. To further augment his defence, a Paladin should not miss the Herald of Zakarum, the best shield that this holy avenger can hold.

■ The Sorceress

The Sorceress can be quite a challenge to play with—she should avoid direct contact with enemies and hone her skills in specialised magic. Blizzard, Glacial Spike, Frozen Orb, Fire Ball, Blaze, Static Field, Nova and Chain Lightning are some of the spells that will go a long way in improving your chances of survival as a Sorceress. No monster-hating career woman should be caught without the Oculus, which in conjunction with a good shield, will see you through most bad days.

Getting There

The Secret Cow Level

You can moo your way to a Secret Cow Level after finishing the game. Get back to the Rogue Encampment, put Wirt's Leg and a Tome of Town Portal into the Horadric Cube, transmute it and a portal leading to the bovines will appear. Once you kill the Cow King, you cannot return to these green pastures. Keep him alive and milk the place for items and gold.

To Kill a Beast

Fire resistance is highly essential in the final showdown with the menacing Diablo. You can use the Horadric Cube to transmute a ring of fire resistance. To do this, you will need one ring, one ruby and four vials of Exploding Potion. This will give you the Garnet Ring that offers a boost of +21-30 to your fire resistance statistic.